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POST OFFICE GUIDE

PART – I

Rules & Regulations Relating to the Inland Post

Comprehensive Study Material for the LDCE
Inspector of Posts (IP) · PS Group 'B' Examination
**Fully aligned with the Post Office Act 2023, Post Office Rules 2024
& Post Office Regulations 2024 (updated to June 2026)**

DISCLAIMER

This booklet has been prepared by Dak Guru strictly as a study aid for departmental examination preparation. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and to incorporate the latest Acts, Rules, Regulations, gazette notifications and departmental orders in force, errors or omissions cannot be ruled out. This document does not supersede, and is not a substitute for, the Post Office Act 2023, the Post Office Rules 2024, the Post Office Regulations 2024, the departmental manuals, or any gazette notification / circular issued by the Department of Posts. In case of any conflict, the official primary source shall prevail. Readers are strongly advised to verify every provision against the latest official source before relying on it.

Foreword — A Note on the New Legal Architecture

This edition of the Dak Guru **Post Office Guide Part-I** has been rebuilt from the ground up. The original Post Office Guide Part-I was a public compilation of the rules relating to the inland post framed under the **Indian Post Office Act, 1898**, and the **Indian Post Office Rules, 1933**. That entire legal foundation has now been replaced. For the serious aspirant, understanding this transition is not optional — it is the single most examinable development in this subject.

Three instruments now govern everything in this book:

- **The Post Office Act, 2023 (No. 43 of 2023)** — received the assent of the President on 24 December 2023 and **came into force with effect from 18 June 2024** vide Notification No. S.O. 2352(E) dated 17 June 2024. It repeals the Indian Post Office Act, 1898.
- **The Post Office Rules, 2024** — the enabling subordinate legislation framed under the Act.
- **The Post Office Regulations, 2024** — notified vide S.O. 5440(E) dated 16 December 2024 and brought into force from **16 December 2024**. These contain the detailed operational provisions (180 regulations across 15 chapters and 5 Schedules) and replace the Indian Post Office Rules, 1933.

🏛️ LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

Why this matters: The 1898 Act gave the Central Government the **exclusive privilege (monopoly) over conveying letters**. The 2023 Act **abolishes that monopoly** — private couriers may now legally carry letters. The Post Office retains only one exclusive privilege: the **issue of postage stamps** (Section 4). Equally important, **all penal provisions have been removed** — first by the Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Act, 2023 (w.e.f. 29.12.2023), a position carried forward by the 2023 Act, which contains **no offences and no penalties** except the recovery of unpaid charges as an arrear of land revenue.

Throughout this booklet, the symbol 🏛️ **LEGISLATIVE UPDATE** flags a point where the modern position differs from the old Guide or where a recent notification has changed the law. The symbol ★ **EXAM FOCUS** highlights facts that recur in previous-year question papers. Wherever a figure or provision could not be confirmed against a primary source, this has been stated openly rather than glossed over.

How to read the numbers in this book

Monetary figures, weight limits and time-periods quoted here are drawn from the Post Office Regulations 2024, the current India Post domestic tariff, and gazette notifications up to **June 2026**. Tariffs and limits are revised from time to time; always confirm the live figure on **www.indiapost.gov.in** or the latest gazette before quoting it in the field.

CHAPTER 1

The Department of Posts — Organisation & Control

The Department of Posts (DoP), branded as **India Post**, functions under the **Ministry of Communications**. With a network of over 1.6 lakh post offices — the largest postal network in the world, of which roughly 90% are in rural areas — it is far more than a mail carrier. It delivers small-savings banking, Postal Life Insurance, India Post Payments Bank (IPPB) services, Aadhaar enrolment, passport Seva Kendras and a widening basket of citizen-centric services.

Administrative control

At the apex sits the **Secretary, Department of Posts**, who is also the **Director General of Postal Services (DG Posts)** and Chairman of the Postal Services Board — the highest management body of the Department. The Postal Services Board is assisted by Members holding charge of functional portfolios (Operations, Personnel, Technology, Banking & DBT, Planning, Human Resource Development, Philately, etc.) and by the Joint Secretary & Financial Advisor.

LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

Under the **Post Office Act, 2023**, the **Director General** is the statutory authority empowered (with the prior approval of the Central Government) to **make Regulations** on the activities, charges, supply and sale of postage stamps and postal stationery, and the manner of providing postal services (Sections 11–13). The old description of the DG merely as an administrative head has been replaced by this clear statutory rule-making role.

The Circle–Region–Division structure

For administration the country is divided into **Postal Circles**, each generally coterminous with a State and headed by a **Chief Postmaster General (CPMG)**. There are presently 23 Postal Circles. A separate **Base Circle (Army Postal Service)** caters to the defence services. Each Circle is divided into **Regions** under a **Postmaster General (PMG)**, and Regions into **Postal Divisions** under a **Senior Superintendent / Superintendent of Post Offices (SSPOs/SPOs)**. The Railway Mail Service (RMS) is similarly organised into divisions under Superintendents (RMS).

★ EXAM FOCUS

- **Hierarchy to remember:** Directorate → Circle (CPMG) → Region (PMG) → Division (SSPO/SPO) → Sub-Division (Inspector/ASP) → Post Office.
- **The Inspector of Posts (IP)** works at the sub-divisional level — the cutting-edge supervisory cadre and the post for which the LDCE in this syllabus is held.

Classification of post offices

Post offices are classified, on the basis of status and the volume/range of work, into three broad types:

- **Head Post Office (HO)** — the accounting hub of a group of sub-offices; controlled by a Postmaster (often a gazetted officer in the larger cities).
- **Sub Post Office (SO)** — transacts the full range of postal, savings-bank and remittance business but accounts to a Head Office.
- **Branch Post Office (BO)** — located mainly in villages and run by a Gramin Dak Sevak (GDS) Branch Postmaster; offers core services on an agency basis and accounts to an account office (SO/HO).

🏛️ LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

The older expression “Extra-Departmental (E.D.) sub-office / branch office” is obsolete. Extra-Departmental Agents are now **Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS)**, governed by the **GDS (Conduct & Engagement) Rules, 2020**.

CHAPTER 2

Business Hours, Night & Mobile Post Offices

The working hours of a post office are fixed by the **Head of the Circle / Region / Division** with reference to local convenience and the arrival and despatch timings of mails. The hours at which counters open and at which mails are cleared and delivered are conspicuously displayed at every office.

Public business hours — the working pattern

- **Enquiry & reference:** available during the **entire working hours** of the office.
- **Booking counters** (registration, insurance, parcels, money remittance such as eMO and IPO, sale of stamps & stationery): generally for about **six hours**.
- **Savings Bank transactions:** generally for about **six hours**.
- **Branch Post Offices:** remain open for a **maximum of five hours** a day.

Night Post Offices

To meet special public demand, the Head of Circle / Region may authorise selected offices to function as **Night Post Offices**, transacting specified business on days and at hours beyond the normal working pattern — including **Sundays and holidays**. The range of business they may transact is restricted to that specifically authorised.

Mobile Post Offices

Mobile Post Offices are vans that provide late-posting and counter facilities along a fixed route and schedule in city areas.

- They remain **closed on Sundays and Postal Holidays**.
- They do **not** accept **Insured** or **Cash-on-Delivery (COD)** articles.

Business on Sundays & Postal Holidays

As a rule all post offices (and mobile offices) remain closed on Sundays and notified Postal Holidays. The principal exceptions are:

- **Night Post Offices** — remain open for authorised business.
- **RMS offices / sorting offices** — continue mail processing and may sell stamps and book registered articles during specified hours.
- **Street letter boxes** are **not cleared** on these days; machine-franked articles must not be posted in letter boxes on closed days and, if so posted, are treated as unpaid.

LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

The **late fee** formerly charged for posting after the latest hour of clearance (and for posting on closed days) was **abolished** with effect from the notification **G.S.R. 912(E) dated 29 December 2022**. The columns for “late fee” that appear in old Guides and tariff sheets are therefore no longer operative for ordinary posting.

CHAPTER 3

Prepayment of Postage — Stamps, Stationery & Franking

Postage must, as a rule, be **prepaid**. Under **Rule 9 of the Post Office Rules, 2024**, postage and other charges on an item may be prepaid by any of the recognised modes — **postage stamps, postal stationery, franking impression, or digital / electronic payment**. The 2023 Act expressly recognises postage stamps “physical or digital”, opening the door to digital postage.

Exclusive privilege over postage stamps

Section 4 of the Post Office Act, 2023 vests in the Post Office the **sole and exclusive privilege of issuing postage stamps**. This is the **only** monopoly the Department retains after the abolition of the letter monopoly. The DG may make regulations on the supply and sale of stamps and postal stationery.

Spoilt, defaced and fictitious stamps

- Spoilt or defaced stamps and damaged postal stationery are **not** exchanged or refunded across the counter as a matter of right.
- A **fictitious stamp** (any imitation, or anything purporting to be a stamp not issued by the competent authority) must not be made or used.

LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

Penal liability for fictitious stamps no longer flows from the Post Office Act (which now has no penal clauses) but from the general criminal law. Counterfeiting / using fictitious Government stamps is dealt with under the **Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 (BNS)**, which has replaced the Indian Penal Code, 1860. The relevant fictitious-stamp offence corresponds to the erstwhile IPC § 263A.

Caution – verify the section number: Different secondary compilations cite different BNS section numbers for this offence. The exact BNS section should be confirmed against the bare BNS text before it is quoted as definitive.

Previously-used stamps & invalid stamps — administrative instruction

The manner of dealing with a **previously-used postage stamp**, affixed fraudulently or with intent to cause loss to the Government, is prescribed under **Regulation 9(2)** of the Post Office Regulations 2024, as operationalised by **PO Order 01/2024 dated 16.12.2024** (consolidated in the Department’s compilation order F.No. 01-02/2025-PO dated 04.12.2025). The position is:

- If a **previously-used stamp** (from which no attempt has been made to remove the obliteration marks), or a **service stamp** on a private item (from which the word “service” has not been removed), is detected on a posted item, the stamp is **ignored**; the item is charged the postage it thus becomes liable to and forwarded to destination with a remark, a note being made in the error book.
- Stamps that are **defaced, obliterated, marked, separated from stationery, torn, cut or otherwise rendered imperfect** are **not recognised** in payment of postage; such a stamp is not defaced further, but a remark is written on the item explaining why it was ignored.
- Stamps **perforated with initials / identifying marks** in minute holes **may** still be used (this is not a prohibition).

🔗 LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

Two examinable rules from PO Order 01/2024: (i) a postage stamp must be affixed by the **sender or his messenger** — **never by an official** of the Department; and (ii) an item addressed to the CVC or a CVO bearing the superscription “**Complaint under the Public Interest Disclosure**” or “**PIDPI Complaint**” may be accepted for transmission **without the name and address of the sender** (“PIDPI” is entered in the sender field at booking) — Regulation 20.

Franking — the Remotely Managed Franking System (RMFS)

Bulk mailers may prepay postage by impressing it on the article with a **franking machine** instead of affixing stamps. India Post has migrated entirely to the **Remotely Managed Franking System (RMFS)**, branded “**Digifrank Plus**”. The governing law is **Regulation 176** of the Post Office Regulations 2024; the detailed working is laid down in the **Standard Operating Procedure on RMFS for Digifrank Plus** (originally issued vide letter No. 9-6/2007-PO(Pt) dated 27.04.2012 and re-circulated through the 2024 compilation).

What makes RMFS different from the old franking machine

Older machines used mechanical seals and were physically reset at the post office. An RMFS machine uses **inkjet printing** and is **reset remotely** by a central **RMF Server** maintained in India by each manufacturer. Funds sit in a tamper-proof **Postal Security Device (PSD)** that **cannot be repaired** — if it fails it is replaced and a fresh licence issued. The frank is a secure, unique **digital** impression carrying a 2-D barcode, and no mechanical sealing is needed.

Key participants — the vocabulary RMFS questions test

- **Licensing Authority:** the Head of the Postal Division / independent Gazetted Postmaster / Directors of the Mumbai, Kolkata & New Delhi GPOs / Officer Commanding a Postal or SDS Unit / SBPO, within whose jurisdiction the machine is located.
- **OEM (Original Equipment Manufacturer):** the company that manufactures the machine and runs the RMFS Centre in India.
- **FMV (Franking Machine Vendor):** the firm authorised by the OEM to sell, install and maintain machines; only the FMV may service a machine.
- **FMU (Franking Machine User):** the holder of a valid postal franking licence.
- **DCR (Department of Posts Central Resource):** a designated officer of the rank of **Director**, the single point of contact between the Department and each OEM's RMFS server.
- **DPO / DMO:** the Designated Post Office / Mail Office — **not below a double-handed office** — authorised to accept the franked mail; **only one** such office is allotted per machine.
- **PSD (Postal Security Device):** the tamper-proof fund store inside the machine; never repaired.
- **CRN (Customer Reference Number):** a unique number issued by the Licensing Authority — the **same as the licence number**. Format: two-letter Circle code + two-digit Division code + a five-digit serial (e.g. **DL09 00001** for the first licence of New Delhi GPO Division).
- **Licence Identifier:** the unique machine number assigned by the OEM, in the form **X123456**, where the letter denotes the OEM (N – Neopost/Quadient, P – Pitney Bowes, F – Francotyp Postalia) and the six digits are the machine's serial.

Categories of licensee

- **Individual licensee:** a person, firm or organisation franking its own mail (or that of a **sister concern** — same premises, or a holding/subsidiary, or one with a common Chairman/Managing Director).
- **Commercial licensee:** either a **Mailing Agent** (sends articles on behalf of and **in the name of** a third party) or a **Registrar** (sends third-party articles but **in the Registrar's own name**). A commercial licensee must submit a list of clients with their consent letters.

Approved vendors and machine models — Regulation 176(1)

Only the vendors and models approved by the Director General may be used. As notified in the 2024 administrative instructions:

Approved vendor	Permitted models
M/s Pitney Bowes India Pvt. Ltd.	DM 100i, DM 130i, DM 140i
M/s Quadient Solutions India Pvt. Ltd. (formerly Neopost)	IJ25, IJ40, IJ50, IJ70, IJ80, IJ90, IJ110

LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

The administrative instruction expressly directs that the Quadient models **IS350, IS420, IS440 and IS480 shall NOT be procured** by the Department of Posts. Francotyp Postalia machines were historically listed in the SOP but **have not been approved for sale** in India.

Licensing, fees and timelines

- The user buys an approved machine from an FMV, deposits the **licence fee of ₹375 (for five years)** — confirmed by **Regulation 176(4)** — at any post office (ACG-67 receipt, credited to UCR), and applies through the FMV to the Licensing Authority.
- The Licensing Authority issues the **Certificate of Licence within 10 working days** (no field verification is required where the applicant is a Government / quasi-Government body).
- After licence issue, an **advance for the first setting of a minimum of ₹2,000** is deposited (into SBI or a post office with e-payment); the machine is normally ready for use within **14 working days** of the application.
- **Renewal:** must be initiated at least **one month** before expiry; renewal is completed within **five working days**. Failure to apply in time attracts a surcharge of **₹100**. If not renewed, the account is blocked after expiry and the licence may be **cancelled three months** after expiry, after a 15-day show-cause notice.

Recharging (uploading credit) and server discipline

- **First setting:** minimum **₹2,000**; every subsequent recharge a minimum of **₹1,000 in multiples of ₹100**.
- Payment is made by internet banking to **SBI**, or by e-payment at a post office; the **DoP server dials the bank server daily at 10:00 p.m.**; funds clear in one day (drafts / internet banking) or three days (cheques).

- Each OEM's RMFS server dials the DoP Central Resource three times every working day — 09:30–10:00, 13:30–14:00 and 16:30–17:00 hrs — exchanging credit, usage and remaining-fund files.
- The machine must dial the RMFS server **at least once within any 30-day period** (for funds or merely an inspection call); if it does not, it is **blocked**, and is unblocked only when it next dials in and uploads its data.
- Resetting is done only remotely by the RMFS Centre; the user pays an **Annual Resetting Fee in advance** to the OEM, failing which funds cannot be downloaded.

Depositing franked mail

- The article is weighed on an electronic scale interfaced to the machine, the **product class** selected, and the machine itself computes and sets the postage (the user cannot key in weight or postage manually).
- **The frank impression must be BLUE**, printed on the **top-right corner** of the address side (or on a label firmly pasted there).
- Two copies of the **Statement of Mailing (SOM)** are printed; one is pasted in the user's Record Book and the second handed in with the mail.
- Franked mail must be handed in at the **designated office on the very day of the date of frank**; if that is not possible it may be accepted the next working day, **but a fresh SOM must be printed** on the actual date of presentation. **Franking with an advance date is not allowed** and such mail is refused.
- Franked articles dropped in a letter box are treated as **unpaid**.

Rebates and refunds

- **Standard rebate** — 3% on the franked value at the time of credit upload, subject to a **minimum consumption of ₹5,000** (claimed on Form ACG-17).
- **Additional rebate** — 2% for presenting franked mail **sorted PIN-code-wise**.
- **Refund for erroneous impression**: face value **less a 5% deduction**, on surrender of the wrapper/envelope, claimed within **one month**.
- **Refund of unused units**: only on **condemnation / discontinuation** of the machine or a faulty PSD.

Suspension vs cancellation — a favourite distinction

- **Suspension ("Blocked" / "Withheld")**: a **temporary, reversible** status — the meter cannot be re-credited until the Licensing Authority re-activates it.

- **Cancellation:** a **non-reversible** status — once a meter is “Cancelled” it can never again be used to re-credit or frank; the machine prints only an “Uninstalled / VOID” impression and can safely be left with the customer.

Records, repairs & advertising

- The FMV maintains a **Register of Repairs**, preserved for **two years** from the last entry; the Authorised Officer visits the vendor’s premises **once every six months**.
- Both the FMU and the Designated Office keep a **Record Book** with the Certificate of Licence pasted in it, open to inspection.
- An **advertisement / slogan** may be printed beside the date-stamp, but **not more than one** slogan or advertisement on a single article.
- Any postage due on cancellation is recoverable; the user’s advance is refunded and dues are recovered, ultimately **as an arrear of land revenue**.

★ EXAM FOCUS

RMFS rapid-fire (Reg 176 + SOP): brand “Digifrank Plus”; licence fee ₹375 / 5 years; blue impression on top-right; first setting ₹2,000, recharge ₹1,000 + multiples of ₹100; RMFS server dials DCR thrice daily (0930–1000/1330–1400/1630–1700); 30-day no-dial → reversible block; rebate 3% (min ₹5,000 consumption) + 2% PIN-sorted; erroneous-impression refund face value less 5% within 1 month; repair register kept 2 years; one slogan per article; suspension reversible, cancellation non-reversible; PSD never repaired. Approved vendors: Pitney Bowes & Quadient (Neopost).

CHAPTER 4

General Rules as to Posting & Method of Address

Packing, sealing and posting

- Every article must be so **packed** as to protect the contents, to bear the marks of handling, and not to injure any person or soil other articles.
- Coins, bullion, jewellery, currency and the like must **not** be sent in an **uninsured** article (see Chapter 9).
- Articles requiring special treatment (perishables, liquids, fragile goods) must conform to the prescribed packing conditions.

Method of address

A complete and correct address — including the **PIN code** — is the foundation of correct delivery. The **Postal Index Number (PIN)** is a six-digit code introduced on 15 August 1972; the first digit denotes the region, the first two the sub-region/circle, the first three the sorting district, and the last three the delivery post office.

LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

Section 5 of the Post Office Act, 2023 empowers the Central Government to prescribe **standards for addressing, address identifiers and the use of postcodes**, and expressly contemplates a **digital address code / digital PIN**. India Post has rolled out **DIGIPIN** (a geo-coded digital address grid) and the **DHRUVA** address-stack initiative to give every address a precise, machine-readable identifier.

Mail for the Defence Services

- Mail for service personnel routed through an **Army Post Office (APO)** must show the **Number, Rank, Name and Unit**, addressed in the care of the field post office (for example, “C/o 56 APO” or “C/o 99 APO”).
- **Green Envelopes / Forces Letters** are concessional letter forms; no postage due is recovered from the addressee where they bear the date stamp of an Army Post Office.

Certificate of Posting & recall of articles

- **Certificate of Posting** gives the sender proof that an article was handed in (it is **not** proof of delivery and carries no compensation).
- **Recall**: a sender may ask for an article to be returned (or its address altered) before it is despatched or delivered, on payment of the prescribed fee and proof of identity.

CHAPTER 5

Classification of Postal Articles (Mail Products)

The single most important structural change brought by the **Post Office Regulations, 2024** is the **rationalisation of mail and parcel products** on the principle of “**one product for one need.**” Overlapping legacy products have been subsumed into a small number of umbrella products, obsolete products withdrawn, and weight/dimension conditions modified.

First-class and second-class mail

Mail is still broadly divided into **first-class** and **second-class**. **Letters, letter cards and post cards** are first-class mail — given priority and entitled to air-lift within India without surcharge under the **All-Up Scheme**. All other articles (book post, registered newspapers, pattern & sample packets, blind-literature packets, etc.) are second-class mail.

The classes of inland postal articles

For the purposes of the inland post the principal classes of postal article are:

Class of article	Nature / typical use	Mail class
Letter	Any communication in writing; the residual class	First
Letter Card	Single folded sheet, no enclosure (max 5 g)	First
Post Card (single / reply)	Open card for short communication	First
Book Post / Printed Post	Printed books, papers, documents (no current personal communication)	Second
Pattern & Sample Packet	Bona-fide trade samples	Second
Blind Literature (Literature for the Blind)	Braille / special material for the visually impaired	Second
Registered Newspaper	Newspaper registered with the Post Office	Second
India Post Parcel	Surface parcel — now compulsorily accountable	—
Speed Post (EMS)	Time-bound express letters & parcels	—

LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

Class of article	Nature / typical use	Mail class
Under the rationalised scheme, the parcel has been made compulsorily “accountable”, carrying track-and-trace by default — a deliberate move to support small businesses and MSMEs. The old free-floating “unregistered parcel” concept is effectively gone: the two umbrella parcel products are India Post Parcel (surface) and Speed Post Parcel (air / express). “Value Payable Post (VPP)” has been merged into Cash-on-Delivery (COD), and COD has been extended to retail customers.		

Blind-literature (Literature-for-the-Blind) packets

- Exempt from **postage, registration fee** and the **acknowledgement / attested-copy fee**.
- Free transmission is by **surface route only**; if airlift is desired, only the air-surcharge is payable.

★ EXAM FOCUS

Classic exam trap: Literature for the blind is exempt from postage **and** the registration fee, but if the sender wants it sent by air, the **airmail/air-surcharge** is still payable. Free carriage is surface-only.

CHAPTER 6

Letter-Mail Products in Detail

Letters

- **Maximum weight:** 2 kg.
- **Unpaid letter:** charged on delivery with **double the deficient postage**; an insufficiently paid letter is charged with double the deficiency.

Post Cards

- **Dimensions:** 14 cm × 9 cm; used for transmission **within India only**.
- **Varieties:** single card and reply card; privately made cards must not be thinner or more flexible than the embossed card.
- A **printed post card** (one carrying a printed communication) is charged at a higher rate than a single card.

Letter Cards

- **Maximum weight:** 5 grams; **no enclosure** is permitted.
- **Penalty:** if a letter card exceeds 5 g or infringes the conditions, it is treated as a **letter** and charged with **double the deficiency** at the letter rate.

Book Post / Printed Post

- Carries printed books, papers and documents; it must **not** contain any current personal communication (a few permitted exceptions apart).
- An unpaid book packet is charged **double postage**; on a breach of conditions it is charged with the **letter or parcel postage, whichever is less**.

Current inland tariff (ready reference)

The following are the standing rates of postage for the principal inland articles. **Always confirm the live figure on the India Post “Domestic Tariff” page before quoting**, as rates are revised by gazette notification.

Article	Slab	Postage (₹)
Post Card (single)	—	0.50
Reply Post Card	—	1.00
Printed Post Card	with printed communication	6.00

Article	Slab	Postage (₹)
Inland Letter Card	max 5 g	2.50
Letter	up to 20 g	5.00
Letter	every additional 20 g	5.00
Book / Pattern / Sample packet	first 50 g	4.00
Book / Pattern / Sample packet	every additional 50 g	3.00
Registration fee	per accountable article (basic)	see Ch. 9

🔗 LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

These basic letter-mail rates have remained stable, but the **Speed Post (document)** tariff was revised with effect from **1 October 2025** (see Chapter 8), and **GST** is now shown separately on Speed Post and parcel charges rather than being embedded in the rate.

CHAPTER 7

Registered Newspapers & Bulk Posting

A newspaper may be **registered with the Post Office** to enjoy concessional second-class rates. The governing definition of a “newspaper” now flows from the **Press and Registration of Periodicals Act, 2023 (PRP Act)**, which has **repealed the colonial Press and Registration of Books Act, 1867**.

LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

Under the PRP Act, 2023, registration of a periodical / newspaper title is now done with the **Press Registrar General of India (PRGI)** through an online portal, replacing the office of the Registrar of Newspapers for India (RNI). A valid PRGI certificate is a pre-condition for **postal** registration of the newspaper.

Postal registration — conditions

- **Registering authority:** the Head of the Division / independent gazetted Postmaster within whose jurisdiction the newspaper is published.
- **Application accompaniments:** two copies of the latest issue, and a copy of the valid PRGI certificate.
- **Timeline:** postal registration is to be granted within **30 days** of a complete application.
- The word “**Registered**”, with the postal registration number, must be printed on the first or last page; the office of posting must be printed on the back page (top-left).
- The newspaper must legibly carry the **name of the printer, place of printing, name of the editor, the publisher and the place of publication**; the **date of publication** must appear on the first or last page.
- It must be published and posted for at least **half its issues** in a calendar year.
- **Weight limit:** a registered newspaper — whether a single copy or a packet — shall **not exceed 5 kilograms** (the same 5 kg ceiling applies to periodical post under Regulation 94).
- **Price is mandatory:** the newspaper must bear a **price, printed on it**; this requirement is waived only for newspapers published by **Ministries / Departments of the Government of India**.
- A publisher may post at a place **outside the jurisdiction** of the registering authority with the permission of the Head of Circle / Region of that place; only a **barcode / QR**

code carrying sender or addressee information (with **no intrinsic value and no commercial use**) may be printed on the copy.

LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

Change in publisher / owner / editor does not, by itself, breach the conditions, provided a written request is filed with evidence that a revised PRGI certificate has been applied for; the **fresh PRGI certificate must be submitted within six months** (the Director General may relax this for Government / PSU / statutory-body publications). A change in **title, place of publication or ownership** requires **fresh registration**.

Renewal of postal registration

- **Validity:** the first registration runs to **31 December of the third calendar year** following the year it takes effect; subsequent renewals are for three calendar years.
- **Renewal window:** application to reach the authority at least **three months** before expiry (i.e. by 30 September); processing within **15 days**.
- **Late fees:** a late fee of **₹50** applies to an application received after the last working day of the third calendar month preceding the last month of the current registration; **₹100** if received after the registration has expired.

Posting Without Prepayment (WPP)

- A publisher posting more than **500 copies** at a time may, by a **separate licence** (in addition to postal registration), post **without affixing stamps**, the postage being billed.
- **Authority:** Head of Circle / Region; the licence number with the prefix “WPP” must be printed below the postal registration number.
- **Security deposit:** equal to one month’s estimated postage (cash in POSB or a nationalised-bank guarantee); the licence is issued within **30 days** (new) / **15 days** (renewal).
- **Billing:** bills are raised on the **16th** (for postings of the 1st–15th) and the **1st** of the next month (for the 16th–month-end); payable within **seven days**; non-payment within a fortnight stops posting and cancels the licence.

Cancellation of postal registration & WPP licence

🔗 LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

New customer-friendly provision. The administrative instructions (PO Order 01/2024, as amended by the PO Division order of 14 November 2025 and consolidated in F.No. 01-02/2025-PO) now expressly allow **cancellation on the customer's own written request**: the **Head of Division / independent Gazetted Postmaster** may cancel the **postal registration** of a newspaper on the publisher's written request, and the **Head of Circle / Region** may cancel the **WPP licence** on written request. Registration may also be cancelled / refused if the conditions of the PRP Act 2023 cease to be met, or on the direction of a competent authority; an aggrieved publisher may appeal to the **Director Postal Services / Head of Region**.

★ EXAM FOCUS

Remember the authorities: PRGI registers the **title**; the **Head of Division** grants/cancels **postal** registration; the **Head of Circle/Region** grants/cancels the **WPP** licence. Weight ≤ 5 kg; price printing mandatory (except GoI publications); renewal late fee ₹50 / ₹100; WPP for > 500 copies. Disputes on a WPP licence → **Member (Operations)**, whose decision is final.

CHAPTER 8

Parcels & Speed Post

India Post Parcel (surface)

Under the Post Office Regulations, 2024, the **India Post Parcel** is the umbrella **surface** parcel product. Key features:

- Postage must be **fully prepaid** through any recognised mode (Rule 9).
- It is **compulsorily accountable** with **track-and-trace**; a **declaration** by the sender accompanies every parcel.
- **Value-added services (VAS)**: addressee-specific delivery, **Cash-on-Delivery (COD)**, **insurance** and **proof of delivery** — each on payment of the prescribed fee.
- Ordinarily transmitted by **surface** (road / rail / waterways).
- **Retention**: an undelivered parcel is retained for **seven days** after the first delivery attempt; the addressee may seek retention for up to seven days in writing.

🏛️ LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

Indicative minimum: a domestic India Post Parcel up to 500 g costs about **₹42** (GST inclusive in the retail parcel calculator). **Weight** is now reckoned as **gross or volumetric weight, whichever is higher** — a definition imported into the 2024 Regulations.

Speed Post (EMS)

Speed Post, launched on **1 August 1986**, is India Post's time-bound express service for documents and parcels. Its **document** tariff — unchanged since October 2012 — was comprehensively revised with effect from **1 October 2025**, notified vide **Gazette Notification No. 4256 dated 25 September 2025**.

Revised Speed Post (Document) tariff — w.e.f. 1 October 2025

Weight slab	Local	≤200 km	201–500	501–1000	1001–2000	>2000 km
Up to 50 g	19	47	47	47	47	47
51–250 g	24	59	63	68	72	77
251–500 g	28	70	75	82	86	93

(All figures in ₹; GST extra as applicable.)

New Speed Post features (from 1 October 2025)

- **OTP-based secure delivery** — item handed over only on confirmation of an OTP; charge **₹5 per item + GST**.
- **Registration (value-added)** — delivery exclusively to the addressee or an authorised person; charge **₹5 per item + GST** (available for both documents and parcels).
- Online payment, SMS delivery notifications, online booking and real-time tracking.
- **Discounts:** a **10% student discount** on Speed Post tariff, and a **5% discount for new bulk customers**.

★ EXAM FOCUS

High-yield current-affairs fact: Speed Post document tariff revised w.e.f. **01.10.2025** (Gazette No. 4256 / 25.09.2025); new OTP delivery and optional Registration at **₹5 + GST** each; 10% student / 5% new-bulk discount. Campaign tagline: **“Tezi Bhi, Tasalli Bhi.”**

CHAPTER 9

Accountable Mail — Registration, Insurance & VAS

“Accountable” articles are those recorded at every stage and capable of being traced — registered, insured, COD, Speed Post and parcels. Registration and insurance are governed chiefly by **Regulations 132 and 133** of the Post Office Regulations, 2024.

Registration (Regulation 132)

- Registration gives the sender a **receipt** and a recorded chain of custody; certain articles (e.g. insured articles, VP/COD articles above a threshold) **must** be registered.
- **Acknowledgement (AD):** the sender may obtain an acknowledgement of delivery signed by the addressee on payment of the AD fee.

Items which may be tendered for registration — Reg 132(1)

The administrative instructions (PO Order 01/2024) list the classes that, when prepaid with postage, may be tendered for registration at any post office: **Post Cards, Letters, Letter Cards, Book Post, India Post Parcels, Speed Post Parcels, Speed Post Documents, Blind-Literature Packets, Periodical Post and Newspapers.**

Insurance (Regulation 133)

Insurance covers the risk of loss or damage in transmission. **Prepayment of all charges — postage, registration and insurance fee — is compulsory** on an insured article.

🏛️ LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

Major recent change – insurance ceiling raised to ₹5 lakh. Regulation 133(1) originally capped the insurable value of a domestic item at **₹1 lakh**. By the **Post Office (Third Amendment) Regulations, 2026** (S.O. 1595(E) dated 25 March 2026), the words “not exceeding one lakh rupees” were substituted by “**not exceeding five lakh rupees**”, with effect from **1 April 2026**. (The principal Regulations were S.O. 5440(E) dated 16.12.2024, amended by S.O. 1329(E) dated 13.03.2026.)

Insurance fee (current)

- **Speed Post parcel:** ₹4 for the first ₹200 of value, and **1.50%** of the value above ₹200.
- **Other domestic accountable items:** ₹10 for the first ₹200, and **₹6 for every additional ₹100.**

- **Compulsory insurance:** insurance is compulsory for at least the amount to be recovered where, in a **VP/COD** article, that amount exceeds **₹100** (intrinsic-value documents apart).

Value-Payable / Cash-on-Delivery (COD)

🔥 LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

The legacy **Value Payable Post (VPP)** has been **merged into Cash-on-Delivery (COD)** under the 2024 Regulations, and COD has been **extended to retail customers**. COD is now offered as a **value-added service** on the parcel and Speed Post products rather than as a separate class of article.

Proof of Delivery (Regulation 136)

- Proof of Delivery (POD) furnishes the sender documentary confirmation of delivery; it is offered as a VAS on parcels (commonly costing a few rupees extra per article).

When compensation is NOT payable

By long-standing rule, retained in the new framework, no compensation is payable where, for example —

- the article has been delivered and the AD signed and returned; or
- the sender did not give intimation of loss within the prescribed period (broadly **six months** for parcels / registered / insured items posted, and **four months** for EMS items, under the 2024 Regulations); or
- the loss or damage arose from **improper or insecure packing**, or from the nature of the contents, or where there is no visible damage to the cover or seals; or
- the article contained currency / bullion not insured for its actual value, or anything prohibited by post.

★ EXAM FOCUS

Numbers worth memorising: insurance ceiling **₹5 lakh** (w.e.f. 01.04.2026); Speed-Post-parcel insurance fee ₹4 + 1.50%; other items ₹10 + ₹6 per ₹100; compulsory insurance where COD recovery exceeds ₹100; complaint window 6 months (parcels/registered/insured) and 4 months (EMS).

CHAPTER 10

Delivery, Redirection & Poste Restante

Delivery of articles

- **Damaged registered article (inland):** a notice is issued to the addressee to attend the post office within **seven days**; for a **foreign** damaged article the period is **fifteen days**.
- **Parcels:** a fully-prepaid parcel (other than COD / Poste Restante) is taken out for delivery **twice**; if still undelivered it is detained for window delivery.
- **Detention / demurrage:** at the addressee's written request an article may be retained for a maximum of **seven days** from receipt; warehousing charges apply on VP/COD articles detained beyond seven days.

Identity (Identification) Cards

- **Issued by:** Head Offices only.
- **Validity:** three years from issue.

🔗 LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

Fee – sources differ. The standing India Post tariff sheet lists the Postal Identity Card fee as **₹9 (valid 3 years)**. Some recent departmental/coaching compilations quote a higher composite figure (application + processing). **Verify the current fee against the live India Post tariff before quoting it;** do not treat the higher figure as confirmed.

Poste Restante

Poste Restante (“to be called for”) lets travellers and strangers receive mail at a post office counter rather than at an address.

- A person may use the facility for not more than **three months**.
- **General articles** are retained for **fifteen days**; **VP/COD articles** for **seven days**.

Redirection

- Articles may be redirected to a new address of the addressee; first-class mail is generally redirected **free**.
- **Change-of-address instructions** are valid for **three months**.
- **Standing instructions** to deliver to a person other than the addressee (e.g. a messenger) lapse after **three years** unless renewed.

Post Box & Post Bag — Regulations 46 & 47

A **Post Box** (a locked pigeon-hole in the post office that the customer clears himself) and a **Post Bag** (a locked bag, supplied by the customer, into which mail is placed for collection or which is used to despatch prepaid mail) are conveniences for which a fee and a security deposit are charged. The conditions, settled by PO Order 01/2024, include:

- Availability of a Post Box at a particular office is determined by the **Head of Circle**; the fee is **paid in advance and is never refunded or adjusted**, and a security deposit (fixed by the Head of Circle) is taken.
- Only **fully-prepaid unaccountable items** are delivered through a post box; accountable items are delivered through it only on the customer's written request (and such delivery is deemed delivery to the addressee).
- A change in the customer's business address must be intimated within **seven days**, failing which the box may be withdrawn without notice.
- If the lock or key is lost or damaged, the customer must inform the Postmaster within **seven days** and bear the cost of repair / replacement, failing which the **security deposit is forfeited**.
- Application for **renewal** is made at least **15 days** before expiry; the period of allotment runs from the first day of the month of allotment.
- If the customer does not clear the box for **a week**, a notice is sent by **registered post**; uncleared items are then delivered by the postman if they bear the customer's address, else treated as undeliverable.
- Items must be addressed to the customer with the **post box number** (and a postal address within the delivery zone); items without the post box number are not delivered through the box.

★ EXAM FOCUS

Time-period grid (Ch. 10): damaged inland article – 7 days; damaged foreign – 15 days; parcel delivered twice; detention – 7 days; identity card valid 3 years; Poste Restante use – 3 months (general 15 days / VP 7 days); change-of-address – 3 months; messenger authority – 3 years; **Post Box – address change / lost key intimation 7 days, renewal 15 days before expiry, fee non-refundable.**

CHAPTER 11

Undelivered & Prohibited Articles

Treatment of undelivered articles

- An article that cannot be delivered, and whose sender cannot readily be traced, is sent after the prescribed period of detention to the **Returned Letter Office (RLO)** — historically called the “dead letter office” — for opening, ascertaining the sender, and return or disposal.
- The sender remains liable to pay the postal charges due on a returned article.

Prohibited articles

Certain things may not be sent by post at all, or only under strict conditions. The **general prohibitions** cover, broadly:

- anything **explosive, dangerous, inflammable, filthy, noxious or deleterious**, and sharp instruments not properly protected;
- living creatures (other than those expressly permitted, e.g. bees, leeches and silk-worms under conditions);
- intoxicating drugs and **narcotic / psychotropic substances**, and other items whose conveyance is barred by law;
- anything bearing on it, or on its cover, words or marks that are **grossly offensive, indecent, or seditious / prejudicial to law and order**.

LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

With the repeal of the 1898 Act and the absence of penal clauses in the 2023 Act, **the consequences of sending a prohibited article now lie under the general law** (for example, the BNS, the NDPS Act, the Explosives Act, etc.) rather than under a postal-specific penalty. Operationally, a prohibited article detected in transit is **detained at the nearest post office** and dealt with as specified by administrative instructions.

Interception of articles

Section 9 of the Post Office Act, 2023 permits the **interception, detention or disposal** of an item by an officer specially authorised by the Central Government, on the grounds of **security of the State, friendly relations with foreign States, public order, emergency, public safety**, or contravention of the Act / any other law. Items suspected to contain dutiable or prohibited goods may be **handed to the customs or other specified authority**.

CHAPTER 12

Official Postal Articles & Camp Bags

Official (“On India Government Service”) articles

- **Unpaid official article:** charged on delivery at the **prepaid (single) rate** — not double — because it is service mail.
- **Insufficiently paid official article:** charged only the **deficiency**.
- **Official parcels:** prepayment of postage is **compulsory**.

Camp / Special Bags

Camp bags are an exclusive facility enabling certain high dignitaries to receive and send mail while on the move.

- **Eligibility:** the **President, Vice-President, Union Ministers, State Governors** and the **Director General of Posts**.
- **Availability:** booked and delivered on **all days, including Sundays and holidays**.

★ EXAM FOCUS

Official-mail trap: an unpaid **private** letter is charged **double**; an unpaid **official** letter is charged at the **single** (prepaid) rate. Camp-bag eligibility is a favourite one-liner: President, Vice-President, Ministers, Governors, DG Posts.

CHAPTER 13

Money Remittance Services

Money remittance is governed by Chapter “Money Remittance” of the Post Office Regulations, 2024. The traditional **Money Order** survives, but is now operated electronically as the **electronic Money Order (eMO)**.

Money Order (eMO)

- **Definition:** an order issued by the Post Office, on the remitter’s request, to pay a sum of money to the named payee at the payee’s address.
- **Maximum value of a single money order:** ₹10,000 (no fraction of a rupee).
- **Aggregate retail remittance:** total remittance to a single person in a month is capped at ₹25,000.
- **Void money order:** if a money order remains unpaid — to the payee or the remitter — at the **end of the second month following the month of issue**, it is treated as **void**.
- **Forfeiture:** the amount of a money order unpaid **beyond three years** from booking is **forfeited** to the Government of India.
- **Retention:** a money order is retained for **seven days** from presentation / despatch for payment; if unpaid it is returned to the remitter on the first working day after that period (commission is not refunded).
- **Stoppage:** the remitter may stop a money order **free of charge** until the delivery office issues it to the postman; the amount, less commission, is then refunded.
- **Death:** if the payee has died, the amount returns to the remitter; if the remitter too has died, it is paid to the remitter’s legal heir.

📌 LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

Source note on the eMO limit. The current India Post Money-Remittance pages and the Post Office Regulations, 2024 fix the single-money-order maximum at **₹10,000**. Several older secondary pages (and the legacy eMO FAQ) still show **₹5,000** — that figure is **outdated**. The ₹10,000 limit, with the ₹25,000 monthly aggregate, is the position under the 2024 Regulations.

The money order form & message codes — Regulation 148

Booking is done on the prescribed **Money Order Booking Form** (Annexure A to PO Order 01/2024), with a separate **Money Order Payment Form** (Annexure B) and acknowledgement portion. Two practical points are examinable:

- The remitter may select a **standard message code** (a numbered list of set messages — e.g. 1 “money for treatment of illness”, 7 “hearty congratulations on success in examination”, 14 “Shagun for marriage”, 22 “RTI charges”, 23 “others”) instead of, or in addition to, a free-text message.
- The payment form carries the payee’s declaration that he has **not received more than ₹25,000 by money order in the current month** — the operational check on the monthly aggregate ceiling.

Service Money Order — Regulation 145(5)

LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

A **Service Money Order**, of **any amount**, may — after mandatory authorisation by the Postmaster — be booked for the Department’s official purposes to pay (a) **customers** (compensation or other dues); (b) **employees**; and (c) **any other person** for rent of a post-office building or other payment, as the Head of Circle deems fit. The ordinary ₹10,000 ceiling does **not** apply to a Service Money Order.

Payment of a money order in special circumstances — Regulation 150(2)

Where the payee cannot give a valid acquittance, the money order is paid as follows, each time in the presence of a resident witness who attests the receipt:

- **Minor:** to the parent / lawful guardian if the minor lives with them; otherwise to the person in whose care the minor is, before a resident witness.
- **Illiterate payee:** only after taking the thumb-impression / mark before a resident witness.
- **Physically incapable payee:** a responsible person with whom the payee resides signs the receipt before a witness.
- **Mentally incapable payee (“lunatic”):** payment is made to the manager appointed to administer his estate; if none, the money order is returned to the remitter.

Indian Postal Order (IPO)

- **Denominations & commission:** ₹10 (comm. ₹1), ₹20 (₹2), ₹50 (₹5), ₹100 (₹10).
- **Broken amounts:** up to 4 **postage stamps** (aggregate not exceeding ₹9) may be affixed to enhance value (not on a ₹100 IPO).
- **Validity:** encashable without a second commission within **24 months**; between 24 and 36 months a second commission (in stamps affixed to the back) is payable; **beyond 36 months it is not payable.**

- **Encashment:** an IPO is **not** paid in cash across the counter — it is realised through a bank or a Post Office Savings Bank account, and may be **crossed** like a cheque.

Other remittance channels

- **Instant Money Order (iMO), Mobile Money Transfer, International Money Transfer** (e.g. via Western Union / MoneyGram for inbound, and the UPU International Financial System for limited outbound corridors) and **IPPB** digital transfers broaden the remittance basket. The exclusion of “money order” commission for contributions to the **PM’s Relief Fund, PM CARES and Chief Minister’s Relief Fund** continues.

★ EXAM FOCUS

Money-order number set: max single MO ₹10,000; monthly aggregate ₹25,000; void at end of 2nd month after issue; forfeited after 3 years; retained 7 days. IPO denominations ₹10/20/50/100; validity 24 months (second commission to 36 months); never paid in cash across the counter.

CHAPTER 14

Philately

A short philatelic history

- **Scinde Dawk (1852):** Asia's first adhesive postage stamp, introduced in the Scinde (Sindh) province by Sir Bartle Frere.
- **Penny Black (1 May 1840):** the world's first adhesive postage stamp (United Kingdom).
- **First stamp of independent India (21 November 1947):** depicting the national flag with the slogan "Jai Hind", of 3½ annas.

Philatelic Deposit Account (PDA)

- **Domestic PDA:** minimum opening balance ₹200.
- **Foreign PDA:** minimum opening balance ₹1,000; a handling charge of 2% (**minimum ₹5**) applies to foreign customers' transactions.
- **Bureau vs counter:** a **Philatelic Bureau** handles mail orders, PDAs and special cancellations; a **Philatelic Counter** is only for sale of items.

Stamp issue policy

- **Living persons:** no stamp is issued on a living personality.
- **Posthumous:** permissible only **10 years** after death — the exception being a Head of State, who may be commemorated on the **first death anniversary**.
- **Institutions:** commemorated only on the **50th, 75th, 100th, 125th or 150th** anniversary.
- **Definitive vs commemorative:** definitives meet day-to-day postal needs and are reprinted as required; commemoratives are sold at bureaus for **12 months**, with unsold stock released to ordinary counters after **6 months**.

My Stamp & Customized My Stamp (CMS)

- **My Stamp:** a personalised sheet costing **₹300**, containing **12 stamps of ₹5** each (face value ₹60).
- **CMS (corporate):** minimum order **5,000 sheets** (multiples of 5,000), with a flat **20% discount** and at least two months' advance notice; India Post prints **500 extra** sheets for its own sale channels.

Promotion schemes

Deen Dayal SPARSH Yojana

- **SPARSH** = Scholarship for Promotion of Aptitude & Research in Stamps as a Hobby (launched 3 November 2017).
- **Eligibility:** students of **classes VI to IX** of recognised schools, with at least **60% marks** (relaxation **5% for SC/ST**), who are members of a school philately club or hold a PDA.
- **Scholarship:** ₹6,000 per annum (₹500 per month), disbursed into a joint account with parents in **IPPB / Post Office Savings Bank**.
- **Numbers:** up to **920 scholarships** nationally — **40 per Circle** (10 each in classes VI–IX). Selection is by a Philately Quiz (Level 1) and a Philately Project (Level 2).

Dhai Akhar Letter-Writing Competition

- A national letter-writing competition (two categories — up to 18 years and above 18 years), in formats of an **inland letter card (≤500 words)** or an **envelope (≤1000 words)**; the FY 2025-26 edition has been run by the Circles.

Philatelic Advisory Committee (PAC)

- **Chairman:** Minister of Communications; **Vice-Chairman:** Minister of State for Communications; **Member-Secretary:** DDG (Philately).
- **Function:** to advise on the issue of commemorative stamps and the Annual Stamp Calendar; the Committee's tenure is two years and it meets once a year.

★ EXAM FOCUS

Philately rapid-fire: Scinde Dawk 1852; Penny Black 01.05.1840; first Indian stamp 21.11.1947 (Jai Hind, 3½ annas); PDA domestic ₹200 / foreign ₹1,000; SPARSH classes VI–IX, ₹6,000 p.a., 920 scholarships (40/Circle); My Stamp ₹300 for 12×₹5.

CHAPTER 15

Complaints, Liability & Interception

Enquiries and complaints

- Every post office keeps a **Suggestions & Complaints Book**; grievances may also be lodged through the **India Post web portal**, the **national CPGRAMS grievance system**, and the **toll-free customer-care line**.
- Complaint windows under the 2024 Regulations: broadly **six months** from posting for parcels / registered / insured items, and **four months** for EMS items; damage or partial loss must be reported within **24 hours** of receipt.

Liability of the Post Office

LEGISLATIVE UPDATE

Section 10 of the Post Office Act, 2023 retains the principle that the **Post Office shall not incur any liability** with regard to its services **except such liability as may be prescribed**. **No officer** incurs liability **unless he has acted fraudulently, or wilfully caused loss, delay or mis-delivery**. Liability is thus to be defined through the Rules. The Department's position, upheld by the National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission (2023), is that the **Consumer Protection Act, 2019 does not apply** to the government's postal service — a point to state precisely in an answer.

Secrecy and privacy

The duty of secrecy of correspondence continues as an operational and constitutional value. Because the 2023 Act carries **no penal clause** for unauthorised opening of articles, any wrongful interception or opening is now actionable under the **general law and service-conduct rules** rather than under a postal-specific penalty — a change commentators have flagged from a right-to-privacy standpoint.

★ EXAM FOCUS

Liability one-liner: Post Office bears **no liability except as prescribed**; an officer is liable only for **fraud or wilful** loss/delay/mis-delivery; the **Consumer Protection Act, 2019 does not apply** to India Post's service.

Annexure — Key Gazette Notifications at a Glance

A consolidated ready-reckoner of the statutory instruments and notifications relied on in this booklet. Each should be confirmed against the official gazette / India Post before being quoted as authority.

Instrument / Notification	Reference & date	Effect
Post Office Act, 2023	No. 43 of 2023; assent 24.12.2023	Repeals IPO Act 1898; abolishes letter monopoly; no penalties
Commencement of the Act	S.O. 2352(E), 17.06.2024	Act in force w.e.f. 18.06.2024
Jan Vishwas (Amendment) Act, 2023	18 of 2023; w.e.f. 29.12.2023	Removed all offences/penalties under IPO Act 1898
Post Office Rules, 2024	Notified Dec 2024	Enabling rules; modes of prepayment; digital address
Post Office Regulations, 2024	S.O. 5440(E), 16.12.2024	180 regns/15 chapters/5 Schedules; replaces IPO Rules 1933
PO (Amendment) Regulations, 2026	S.O. 1329(E), 13.03.2026	Amendment to the 2024 Regulations
PO (Third Amendment) Regns, 2026	S.O. 1595(E), 25.03.2026	Insurance ceiling ₹1 lakh → ₹5 lakh, w.e.f. 01.04.2026
Speed Post (Document) tariff	Gazette No. 4256, 25.09.2025	Revised tariff + OTP/Registration, w.e.f. 01.10.2025
Abolition of posting late fee	G.S.R. 912(E), 29.12.2022	Late fee for posting abolished
Press & Registration of Periodicals Act, 2023	PRP Act, 2023	Repeals PRB Act 1867; PRGI registers newspaper titles
Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023	BNS, 2023	Replaces IPC 1860; governs fictitious-stamp & related offences
PO Order 01/2024 (admin instructions)	F.No. 01-01/2024-PO, 16.12.2024	Administrative instructions under PO Regns 2024

Instrument / Notification	Reference & date	Effect
		(stamps, post box, newspapers, MO, franking)
Compilation of Administrative Orders 2024	F.No. 01-02/2025-PO, 04.12.2025	Consolidates all PO/MO/Phil/PD/BD orders issued under Reg 178
Newspaper registration cancellation	PO Division order, 14.11.2025	Cancellation of postal registration / WPP licence on customer request
RMFS operating procedure (Digifrank Plus)	Letter 9-6/2007-PO(Pt), 27.04.2012	Standard Operating Procedure for franking machines (Reg 176)

Verification standard

This booklet has been compiled on the Dak Guru standard of **primary-source verification**: the Post Office Act 2023, the Post Office Rules 2024 and the Post Office Regulations 2024 (with their amendments and the administrative instructions issued thereunder) take precedence over the older Post Office Guide and departmental manuals wherever they conflict. Where a figure could not be confirmed against a primary source — notably the Postal Identity Card fee — the uncertainty has been flagged in place rather than resolved by assumption. Tariffs, limits and scheme parameters change; verify the live position on **www.indiapost.gov.in** and the latest gazette before relying on any number in the field or the examination hall.

— End of Post Office Guide Part-I —

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